

Team First

Character **First****GOALS MONTH 5**

- You can explain what psychological safety is and why it affects team performance
- You actively contribute to a safe team climate by asking for help and acknowledging others
- You co-sign a joint team contract that guides the season

The step from "I" to "we" is the hardest in sports. Today you explore what it really means to put the team first, even when it costs you something.

EXERCISE 1 — TEAM CONTRACT**1 My Contribution to the Team Contract**

Write three behavioral rules you personally want to uphold this season — not about winning, but about how you treat your teammates.

I promise to _____

I promise to _____

I promise to _____

Signature _____

Date _____

EXERCISE 2 — INVISIBLE CONTRIBUTION**2 Invisible Contribution**

Write one teammate who did something during the last match or training that nobody noticed but was essential for the team. What did this person do?

Teammate name: _____

What did he or she do?

EXERCISE 3 — ASKING FOR HELP**3 Help Log**

Ask a teammate for help actively at least 3 times this month during training. Write down what you asked and what it produced.

WHAT DID I ASK?

WHAT DID IT PRODUCE?

DATE

_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

"Talent wins games, but teamwork and intelligence win championships."

Michael Jordan — 6x NBA Champion

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SCIENTIFIC FOUNDATION — EVIDENCE PYRAMID

Meta-analysis Frazier et al. (2017) — 136 samples: high psychological safety = significantly better creativity and learning behavior. *Personnel Psychology*.

Longitudinal Fransen et al. (2015) — 23 basketball teams: strong "we" culture = higher performance stability and lower dropout.

Qualitative Edmondson (1999) — teams that dare to ask for help learn faster and perform better long-term.

GUIDANCE TEAM CONTRACT

- 1 Individually write 3 personal promises. Then groups of three: which overlap? Each group proposes one promise.
- 2 Team votes on 5 behavioral rules. Everyone signs. Post in locker room or send digitally.
- 3 Review after 4 weeks: "Are we honoring our contract?" Make this a fixed ritual.

COACH TIPS FOR THIS THEME

Tip 1: Invisible Contribution: read notes aloud at end of month. This changes how players see each other.

Tip 2: Publicly reward "team first" behavior with recognition, not points.

Tip 3: Name your own mistakes as coach. This gives players permission to be vulnerable.

⚠ Competitive players with little playing time may struggle with "team first." Use it for an individual conversation, not a group discussion.

TIMING

- ☐ Explanation psychological safety: 5 minutes
- ☐ Individual Team Contract: 5 minutes
- ☐ Group process toward contract: 15 minutes
- ☐ Signing and closing: 5 minutes
- ☐ Invisible Contribution explanation: 5 minutes